

This state of affairs changes when you retire. When you retire you live without the demands of a prestigious job, business travel, or exclusive neighborhood. Without two washing machines, three computers, and five vehicles. Chapters 4 and 5 suggest you sell the big house and move to cheaper living space. Over time your simple cottage in the North Carolina woods will seem quaint or rustic rather than old. Your eight-hundred-square-foot apartment near the beach in Rio will seem cozy rather than small, eclectic rather than overcrowded. And you'll be able to relax and read every day rather than work to support your assets five days a week and maintain them the other two.

But cutting down on infrastructure means more than selling the house. It also means selling the car.

VEHICLES

If you thought I was missing a few spark plugs when I advised you to sell your home, you must think my engine has frozen up now. You could no sooner live without a car than you could live without food, water, or touch-tone telephone.

But as incredible as it may seem, it *is* possible to live in the 1980s without owning a car. I know. Vicki and I haven't owned a car since 1974.

The last time I drove my own car was in San Francisco on January 1, 1974. I had to work that day because a client was taking inventory. Young auditors prefer that clients count their wares on January 2, 3, or 4, but if clients want to count on New Year's Day their auditors oblige. The warehouse was forty-five minutes south of our apartment in San Francisco. I figured I could drive down, observe the count, and be home by noon to celebrate New Year's with my brother. He was driving from Los Angeles to Seattle that day, and I had persuaded him to detour to San Francisco to visit for a few hours.

A huge rainstorm and the resulting traffic snarl ruined my